

Growth Portal Course Proposal

Observability — 3 Pillars, from Structured Logging to Failure Detection

Ad-hoc Activity Plan, Item 2 · Prepared by Leander · 2026-08-24

Objective

Create and post a course to the Growth Portal on **observability** — the Growth Area identified in my 2-week training plan. The course translates what the training plan covered (structured logging, metrics, distributed tracing, and silent-failure detection) into a short, practical course for other Full Scale engineers, with an accessible entry point for people outside engineering (QA, UI/UX, PM) who work alongside these systems.

Approach

The course teaches **observability concepts**, demonstrated in a real NestJS application built during the training plan — the framework is the vehicle for showing the ideas concretely, not the subject of the course itself. Every technical module explains the underlying mechanism in plain language before any code appears on screen, so the reasoning transfers even to someone working in a different stack.

Because the audience is mixed, the course is structured in two tiers: one short, jargon-free module anyone can follow, followed by technical modules that assume an engineering background.

Module outline

Tier	Module	Covers
Everyone	1. Why observability, and the 3 pillars	No jargon, no code — what a system looks like with no observability vs. with it, and why that gap matters.
Engineers	2. Structured logging + correlation IDs	Tracking one request's behavior across a service without losing context mid-flight.
Engineers	3. Metrics that survive scale	Designing metrics that stay cheap to store and query as traffic grows.
Engineers	4. Distributed tracing	Seeing how one request moves across multiple services, not just within one.
Engineers	5. Detecting silent failure	Catching the failures that produce no error at all — the hardest failure mode to design for.

Format

A recorded, produced video course (scripted, edited, not a single continuous take) posted to the Growth Portal, with each module labelled by tier so viewers can self-select how deep to go.

Execution schedule

Proposed at 6 hours/day, with buffer kept in reserve each day:

Day	Focus	Output
1	Outline + Module 1 scripting	Course outline finalized; Module 1 script drafted and reviewed
2	Modules 2–3 scripting	Scripts drafted, read aloud and checked for framework-tutorial drift
3	Modules 4–5 scripting	Scripts drafted and checked; full run-through of all 5 for pacing
4	Recording	All 5 modules recorded, re-takes as needed
5	Editing + self-review	Cut, tier labels added, reviewed against each module's objective
6	Review + publish	Reviewed with EM, feedback incorporated, published to Growth Portal

This runs in parallel with the other ad-hoc items (SkillIQ assessments, automation project proposal), which are self-paced and scheduled separately.